

Afifah Kashif

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Research interests: AI evaluation [2,3,5,9], human-AI and human-robot interaction [1,4,6,8], and AI governance [3,6–8]

EDUCATION

University of Cambridge <i>M.Phil. Human-Inspired Artificial Intelligence</i> (with Distinction) Dissertation: Bias by Whose Definition? The Construct Validity of Dictionary-Based and LLM-as-Judge Bias Evaluation in Conversational AI (Supervisors: Dr. Jin Huang, Dr. Malak Sadek, Dr. Hatice Gunes)	Cambridge, UK Oct 2025 – Jun 2026
University of Washington, Paul G. Allen School of Computer Science & Engineering <i>B.S. Computer Science, Minor in Law, Societies & Justice</i> Study Abroad: Rome, Italy (Jan – Mar 2024), Honors: <i>The Global Refugee Crisis: From Devastation to Diaspora</i> GPA: 3.77/4.00, Dean's List, Completed one year early Capstone: Ointment Care Robot for Limited Mobility Users (Instructor: Dr. Maya Cakmak)	Seattle, USA Sep 2022 – Jun 2025
Bellevue College <i>A.A. Arts and Sciences; A.S. Engineering, Physics and Atmospheric Sciences</i> Earned concurrently with high school through dual credit; GPA: 3.98/4.00, Dean's List	Bellevue, USA Sep 2020 – Jun 2022

RESEARCH POSITIONS

Visiting Researcher, Stanford University Prof. Julian Nyarko, Dr. Megan Ma (Legal Innovation through Frontier Technology (Lift)Lab, Stanford Law School)	Sep 2026 – Present
Research Assistant, University of Cambridge Dr. Katie Seaborn (Aspirational Computing Lab, Department of Computer Science and Technology), Dr. Malak Sadek (Human Interactions, Values & Experiences with Conversational AI (HIVE) Lab, Centre for Human Inspired AI)	Jul 2026 – Present
Researcher, PluralisticAI Lab Dr. Zhenzhen Qi (University of Connecticut), Dr. Avijit Ghosh (Hugging Face)	Mar 2026 – Present
CORDA Democracy Fellow, Odyssean Institute Jacob Haimes (Apart Research), Dr. Swaptik Chowdhury (RAND)	Apr 2026 – Sep 2026
Research Assistant, University of Washington Dr. Amy Ko (Wordplay Project, UW Information School)	Sep 2024 – Jun 2025

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

Robotics Software Engineering Intern, Hello Robot <i>Human-Robot Interaction and UX focus (Dr. Vinitha Ranganeni)</i>	May 2025 – Aug 2025
Backend Software Engineering Intern, HowellCo	Jul 2024 – Sep 2024
Software Engineering Intern, Code.org	Jul 2023 – Sep 2023
Operations and Product Intern, Fiveable	Apr 2021 – Nov 2021

PUBLICATIONS

- [1] Designing Power Systems as a Social Interface for Assistive Robots**
Afifah Kashif, Vy Nguyen, Vinitha Ranganeni
ACM/IEEE International Conference on Human-Robot Interaction (HRI) 2027. [Under Review]
- [2] Do Language and Visual Perturbations Compound? Interaction Effects and Backend Sensitivity in Compact Vision-Language-Action Model Evaluation**
Abdul Muhsin Hameed, Afifah Kashif, Asim Iqbal
International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR) 2027. [Under Review]
- [3] Synthetic Dataset Creation as Governance Infrastructure for Embodied AI Bias Evaluation**
Afifah Kashif
UK AI Research Symposium (UKAIRS) 2026, Emerging Research Track. [Peer-Reviewed, Accepted]

[4] Beyond the Monolithic Interface: A Research Agenda for Plural Conversational AI

Avijit Ghosh, Afifah Kashif, Isabelle Kohout, Zhenzhen Qi

Humanities and Social Sciences Communications (Nature Portfolio). [Under Review]

[5] Mapping Collective Imaginaries of AI Risk: Expert Elicitation, Causal Modeling and LLM-Assisted Coding

Anshikha Kumar*, Afifah Kashif*, Jacob Haimes, Swaptik Chowdhury

AI4GOOD Workshop @ NeurIPS 2026. [Accepted]

*Equal contribution

[6] Governance as Methodology: Toward Anticipatory, Design-Embedded Governance for Human-Robot Interaction

Afifah Kashif, Malak Sadek

2nd Interactive AI for Human-Centered Robotics Workshop @ ACM/IEEE HRI 2026. [Peer-Reviewed; Presented]

[7] Governance at the Edge of Architecture: Regulating NeuroAI and Neuromorphic Systems

Afifah Kashif, Abdul Hameed, Asim Iqbal

arXiv:2602.01503, 2026. [Preprint]

[8] Regulatory Considerations for Physically Assistive Robotics Researchers

Afifah Kashif, Amal Nanavati, Maya Cakmak

Physical Caregiving Robots Workshop @ ACM/IEEE HRI 2025. [Peer-Reviewed; Presented]

[9] Assessing GPT's Bias Towards Stigmatized Social Groups: An Intersectional Case Study on Nationality Prejudice and Psychophobia

Afifah Kashif*, Heer Patel*

*Equal contribution

Considering Cultural and Linguistic Diversity in AI Applications Workshop @ ASIS&T 2024. [Peer-Reviewed; Presented]

Other Writing

The Hidden Social Costs of AI

EvalEval Coalition. Blog Post. November 2025.

HONORS AND AWARDS

Winner, Hack the Law Research Pitch (2026): Stanford x Cambridge competition for funded research placement.

Top 5 Nominee, Academic Representative of the Year (2026): Cambridge Excellence Awards.

Marcy Migdal Fellowship (2025): UW Center for Global Studies; funded a digital literacy program for recently resettled refugee women.

Nordic Scholars Leadership Institute (2025): Inaugural cohort, Stockholm, Sweden.

Distinguished Leader Award (2023): Harvard WECODE.

TALKS

Panelist, “Intergenerational Perspectives on AI in a Changing World” Jun 2026

Centre for Human-Inspired AI, Annual Conference, University of Cambridge Union

Dissertation Seminar, “Bias by Whose Definition?” May 2026

Centre for Human-Inspired AI, University of Cambridge

Speaker, CHIA Early Career Community Event May 2026

Centre for Human-Inspired AI, University of Cambridge

Guest Lecture, “An Ethical AI Lens for Neuroinclusive Design” Feb 2026

Inclusive Design Futures (Dr. Matteo Zallio), University of Cambridge

Speaker, “The Politics of Educational Technology” Feb 2026

Clareity × Whiston Series, Clare College 700th Anniversary, University of Cambridge

TEACHING

Supervisor, Computer Science and Human-Computer Interaction

University of Cambridge

Oct 2025 – Mar 2026

Cambridge, UK

Founder and Instructor, Digital Literacy Program

International Rescue Committee and Kabul Seattle Community Services

Jan 2025 – Present

Seattle, WA

Teaching Assistant, Intro Programming and The Hardware/Software Interface <i>University of Washington</i>	Jan 2023 – Mar 2025 <i>Seattle, WA</i>
Section Leader, Code in Place <i>Stanford University</i>	Apr 2024 – May 2024 <i>Remote</i>
Language and Literacy Teacher <i>CPIAI Roma</i>	Jan 2024 – Mar 2024 <i>Rome, Italy</i>

SERVICE

Program Committee: UserSim: Grounded User Simulation Workshop @ NeurIPS 2026	
Workshop Host: CMD-IT/ACM Richard Tapia Conference 2024 (first and only undergraduate team)	
Hackathon Organizer: Shared Futures Foundation London Ethics Buildathon, 2026; Techtogether Seattle, 2023	
Member: EvalEval Coalition	2025 – Present
AI Research Events Lead: Cambridge AI Research Society	2026 – Present
Academic Representative: Cambridge Institute of Technology and Humanity	2025 – Present
Executive Officer: Paul G. Allen School Student Advisory Council, University of Washington	2022 – 2024
Co-Founder and Vice President: Women in Law Society, University of Washington	2023 – 2025

LANGUAGES

English (native), Urdu/Hindi (native)